

the need for glasses. This is called as ‘autostereoscopic technology’, and is being developed by a few companies.

Some of these displays can alternate between 2D and 3D viewing—this is achieved by using the revolutionary ‘switchable parallax barrier’ technology. The parallax barrier is a series of vertical slots carefully designed to focus pixels in different directions so the right and left eyes receive different lights; the viewer is thus able to see stereoscopic images and video.



The holographic 3D—a revolutionary display technology

Image separation is accomplished by ensuring the areas viewed are set at the same separation as that of the human eyes—about two and a half inches—so the right eye sees only the right-eye image and the left eye sees only the left-eye image. The parallax barrier is placed between the LCD and the backlight, and can be switched on and off. When off, the LCD acts normally and the screen looks no different from a normal LCD Monitor. This, however, requires a specific piece of software, and is 2D cannot be converted to 3D at the flick of a switch.

Of course you’d ask who needs 2D when you can have 3D all the time, but the point to remember here is that your games may all be 3D, but the display is intended for multiple use—other than just playing games, you can use the display for watching movies, TV programs and the like.

Surround sound is commonplace today, and the newer systems replicate real-life sounds pretty well. But hearing the sound of a tyre screeching, or an explosion, is just part of the experience. What if you could also see and feel the effects of the explosions or a crash? We’re not talking about actually getting burnt or break-